

About Google Analytics

Google Analytics (GA) is the result of Google's acquisition of Urchin software—a Web analytics company. While at the time of acquisition, Urchin offered its services for a cost, post-acquisition, the fees were quickly reduced and finally done away with. As is the case with a few other Google services, initially, GA was by invitation only, but now anyone can use it for free—as long as there are less than 50 lakh visitors every month. More popular Web sites need to sign up for Google AdWords to use GA.

Google's move into this market is seen as a path-breaking one, since free access to analytics tools reduced the dependence of Web sites on firms offering the service. This allowed small and medium sized businesses to discover for themselves the performance of their ad campaigns on different parameters, which ultimately helps them streamline their online marketing practices. Google's move to free up GA was probably prompted by the need to increase the attractiveness of its AdWords programme, which is its lifeline. By integrating AdWords into GA, Google enabled those who used AdWords to make improvements to their strategies based on the data presented by GA. Ad submitters can identify which ads are more effective, which sites are bringing in the most people, what words visitors are searching for on the site, and more. Armed with this information they can fine-tune their online advertising strategies. (It needs to be mentioned here that GA is not limited to tracking Google AdWords performance only.)

```
<script src="http://www.google-analytics.com/urchin.js" type="text/javascript">
</script>
<script type="text/javascript">
_uacct = "UA-90949-1";
urchinTracker();
</script>
```

All it takes is a few lines of code

Using GA

To be able to put GA to any use, you need to have a Web site; a little knowledge of HTML helps. On signing into GA with a Google or Gmail ID, you are asked for a Web site URL you wish to track. The